



Nordic Deal Trend Report

First quarter 2026

—
Danish edition



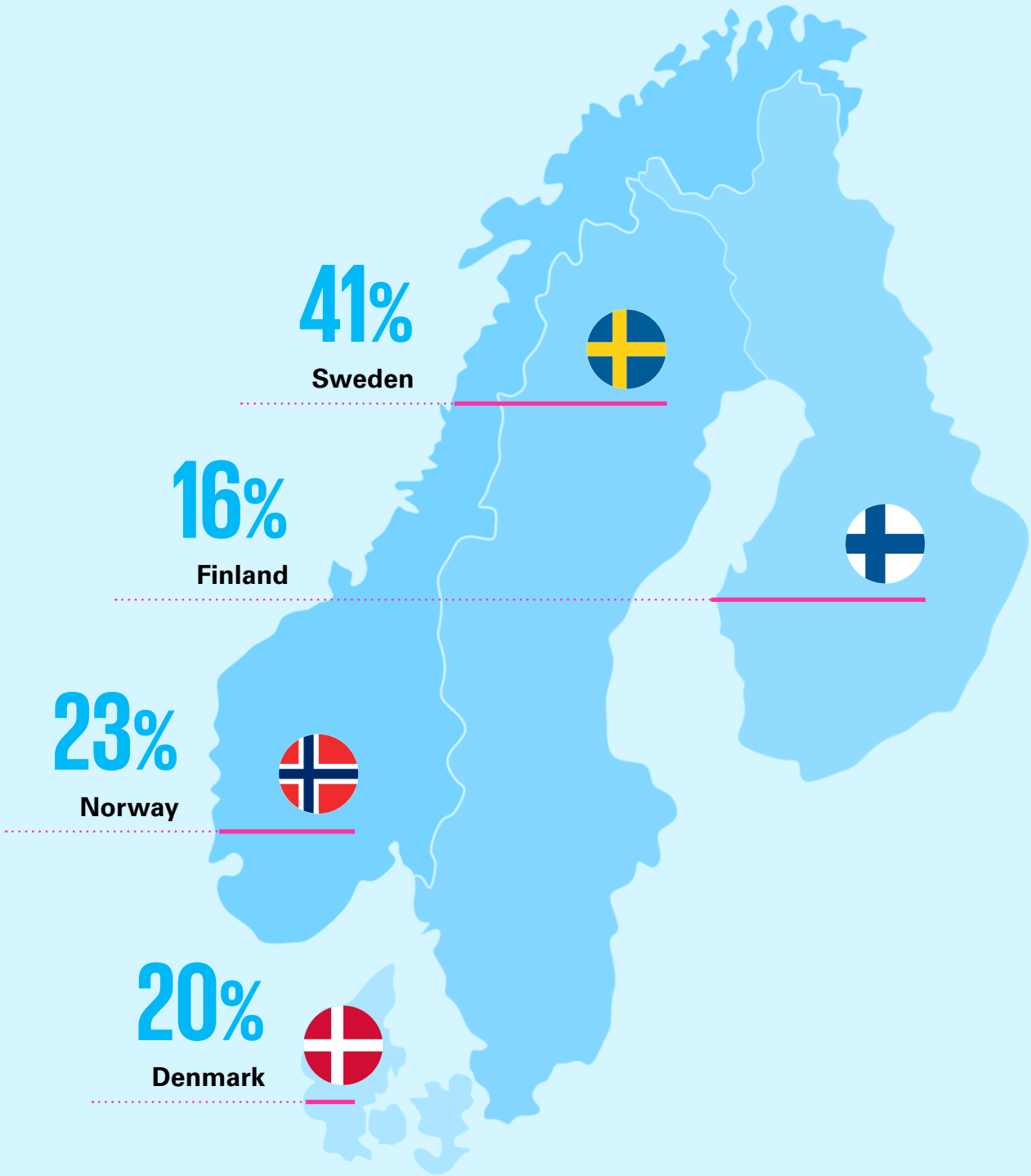
Quarterly distribution by deal count^(a)



What’s hot in the Nordics?^(d)

Sector	Sweden	Norway	Denmark	Finland	Total
Services	50	41	35	24	150
Technology, media & telecommunications	53	30	26	27	136
Manufacturing & industrials	37	22	26	28	113
Construction & real estate	30	24	23	19	96
Consumer & Leisure	21	14	11	16	62
Pharma, medical & biotech	8	11	19	10	48
Energy & natural resources	12	13	7	12	44
Financial services	11	6	14	1	32
Transportation	5	6	4	3	18
Chemicals & materials	3	2	2	4	11
Other	1	0	0	2	3
Total	231	169	167	146	713

Nordic deal flows^(b)



Notes :

Data has been collected up to and including 30 March 2026.

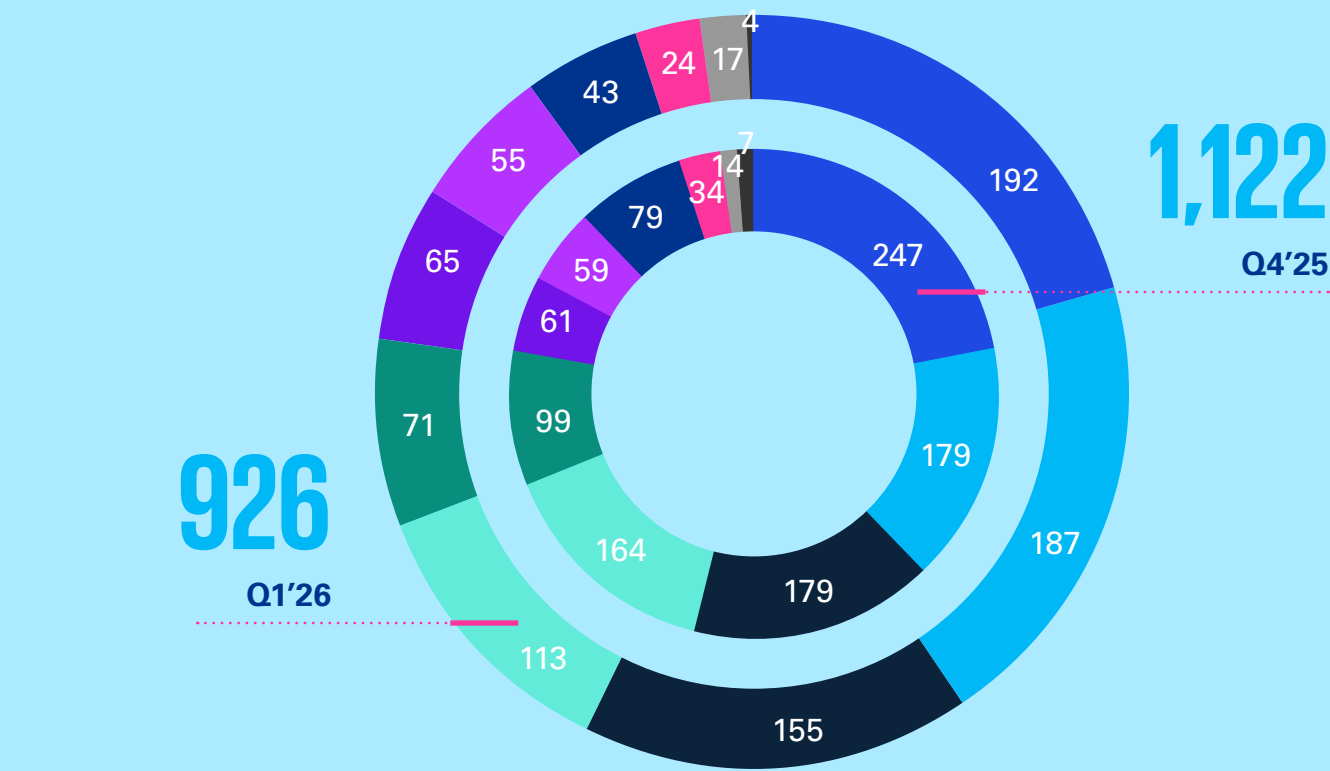
(a) Includes total number of announced deals with a Nordic buyer or a target, excluding deals with lapsed or withdrawn bids.

(b) Percentages denote the proportion per country of the total number of Nordic deals.

(c) Intra-Nordic deals include the deals where both the buyer and the target is Nordic.

(d) The heat chart includes total number of deals with Nordic targets in the quarter (excl. outbound M&A from Nordic region).

Sector breakdown by deal count Q1'26 vs. Q4'25

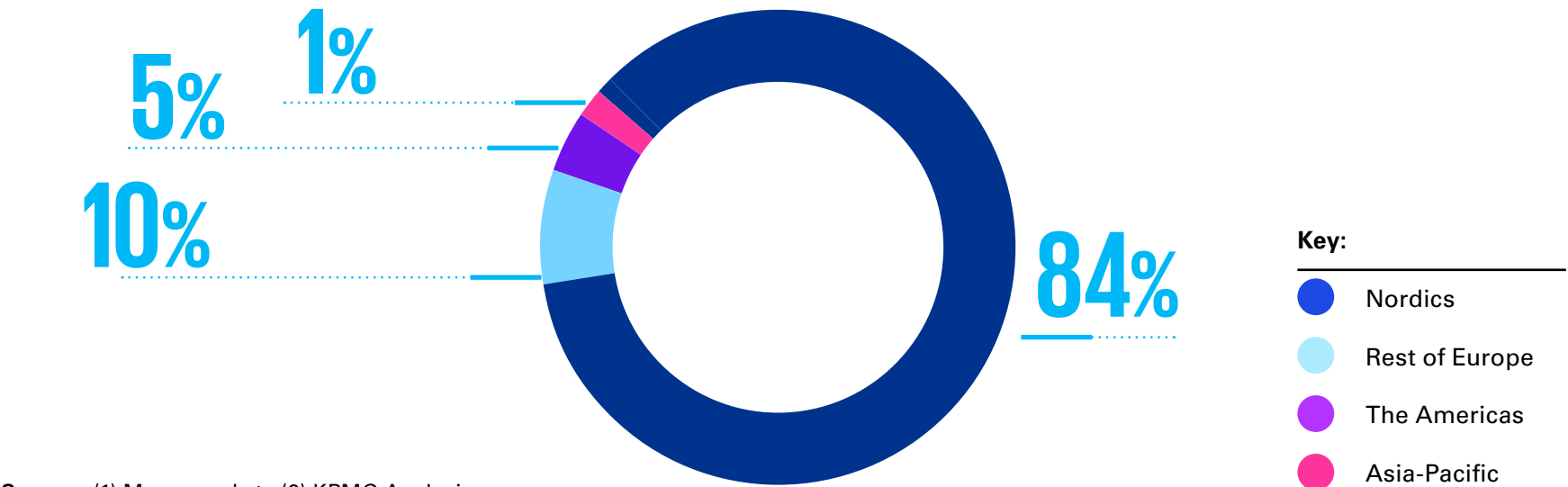


- Key:
- Technology, media & telecommunications
 - Services
 - Manufacturing & industrials
 - Construction & real estate
 - Consumer & leisure
 - Pharma, medical & biotech
 - Energy & natural resources
 - Financial services
 - Transportation
 - Chemicals & materials
 - Other

Top-10 Danish deals in 2026

Target	Buyer	EURm
GN Hearing A/S	Amplifon SpA	2,300
Orsted A/S (European onshore business)	Copenhagen Infrastructure Partners P/S	1,440
Nymolle Stenindustrier	Aalborg Portland A/S; Cementir Holding NV	120
Adserballe & Knudsen A/S; CG Jensen A/S; Ryttermarken Aps; CG Jensen Ejendomme; CG Jensen Ejendomme AS	Per Aarsleff A/S	103
TietoEVERY Oyj (Edlevo and HR & Payroll businesses)	EG A/S	95
Surya Hospitals	Novo Holdings AS; Novo Nordisk Foundation	94
ROCKWOOL Racing SailGP Team	Doug DeVos (Private Individual)	51
Lunar Way A/S	Heartland A/S; Orbit Alliance AB	46
Bactolife A/S	Novo Holdings AS; Athos KG; Cross-Border Impact Ventures; Danish Export & Investment Fund	30
Additive Drives GmbH	AM Ventures Holding GmbH; Nordic Alpha Partners	25

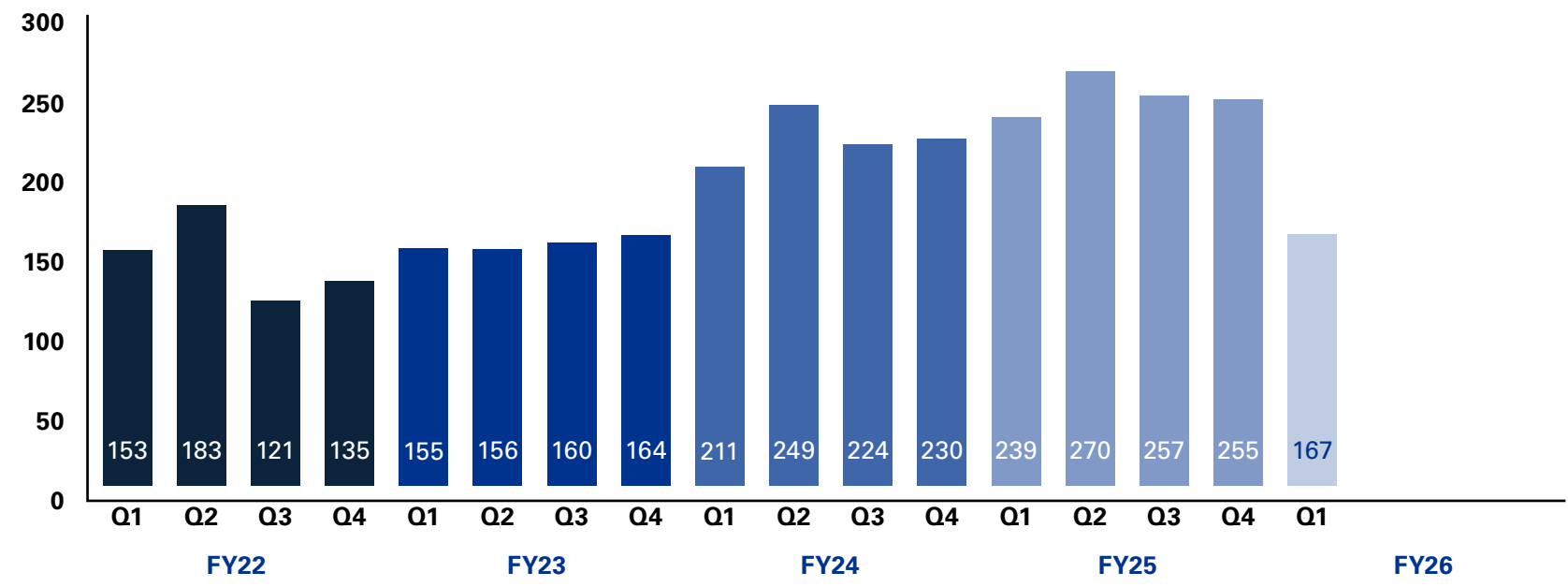
Nationality of buyers of Nordic targets



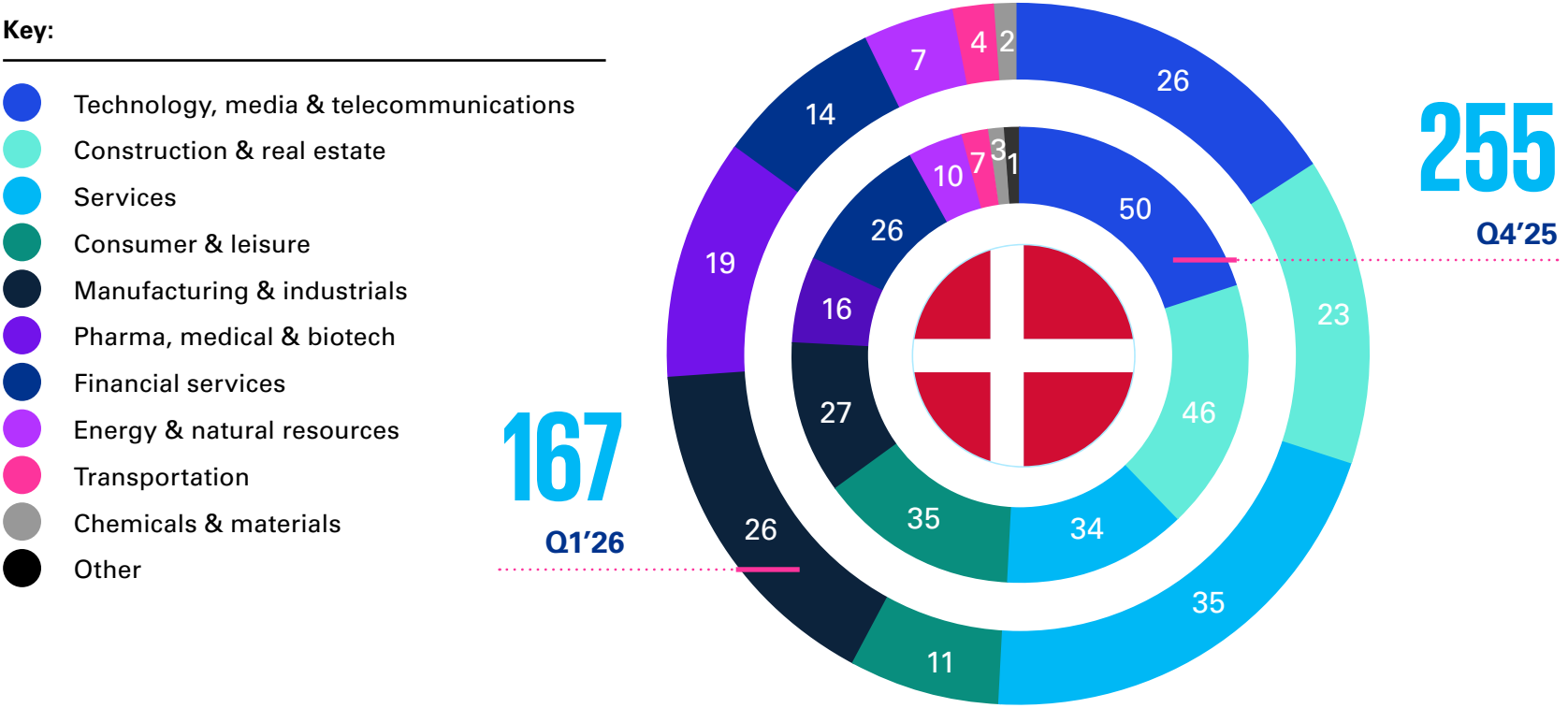
Source : (1) Mergemarket ; (2) KPMG Analysis.

🇩🇰 Spotlight on Denmark

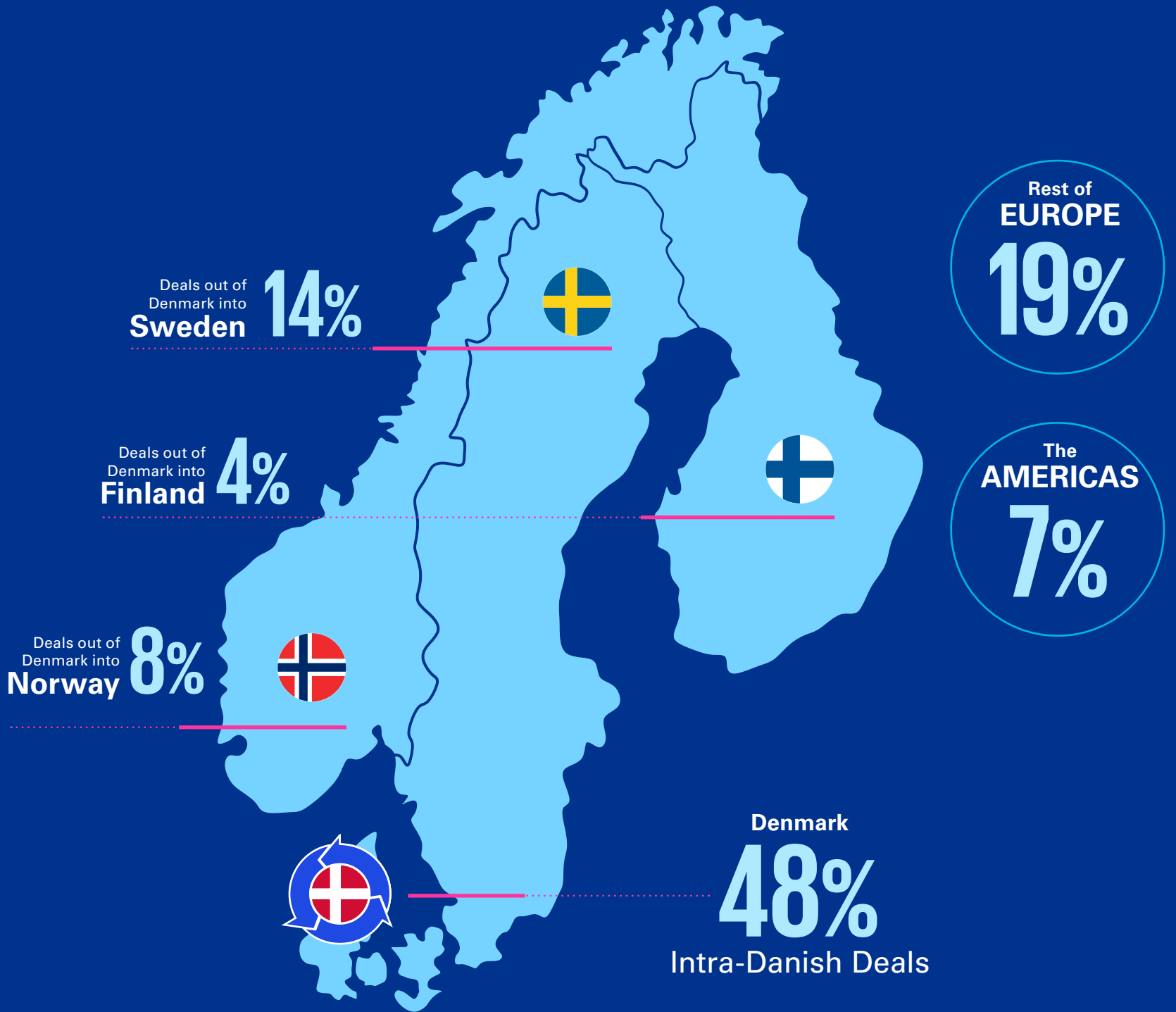
Quarterly distribution by deal count



Sector breakdown by deal count Q1'26 vs. Q4'25



Nationality of buyers of Danish targets



Continued, Nordic steady pace deal activity

Welcome to the first edition of KPMG's Nordic Deal Trend Report of 2026, where we review M&A activity across the broader Nordics with a specific spotlight on deal composition for the Danish market in the first quarter of the year.

As we assess announced deals year to date, activity reflects a continued level of deal activity compared to the previous quarters in terms of volume. Compared to the final quarter of 2025, which recorded 1,122 deals in the Nordics, Q1 2026 has thus far seen 926 announced transactions. While the year has opened with a steady pace, consistent with the pattern we have observed in recent years and continuing the market's focus on quality over quantity, behind the numbers the backdrop remains mixed. Policy uncertainty, lingering trade frictions and increasing geopolitical tension continue to influence deal timelines, prompting some sellers to recalibrate processes and buyers to stress-test assumptions and valuation frameworks.

Looking at sector composition across the Nordics, the distribution of activity remains aligned with recent quarters, while we note that for the Danish sector composition, the picture is slightly different. Here, the services segment takes the lead with 21% of announced deals, followed by a tie between technology, media and telecommunications and manufacturing and industrials (both at 16%), followed by construction and real estate and pharmaceutical deals. In Denmark, these top-5 sectors make up almost 80% of the total announced deals.

Examining the buyer landscape of Danish companies being acquired, Danish M&A seems to be a close to home story. Of the announced acquisitions of Danish targets start of the year, almost half were acquired domestically. When deals do cross the border, they still largely stay in the neighbourhood: Nordic buyers account for 26% (Sweden 14%, Norway 8%, Finland 4%), and a further 19% comes from the rest of Europe. In total, European acquirers drive more than nine in ten transactions (93%).

This proximity bias could point to the advantages of cultural fit, regulatory familiarity, and integrated supply chains within the Nordics and wider Europe. Interest from farther afield is limited - 7% from the Americas and a negligible footprint from Asia Pacific - underscoring that the most reliable buyer pool for Danish companies remains regional.

Looking ahead and taking into consideration the recently announced KPMG report '2026 Global M&A Outlook: The year of the carve-out' exploring how dealmaking is returning in a market defined by greater complexity and higher execution stakes, we note that although that report is based on a global survey of 700 M&A dealmakers across 20 countries and jurisdictions, the same patterns, to a large extent, apply to the Nordic and Danish markets. We expect five drivers, identified in the survey, will also take part in shaping portfolio construction, deal strategy, and value capture in our part of the world.

Strategic focus in a fragmented world - organizations are sharpening portfolio focus to concentrate capital, capabilities, and leadership attention where advantage can be sustained.

Diverging risk appetites between buyers - buyer mandates and execution infrastructure are creating a multi-speed market and reshaping competition for assets.

Portfolio simplification as a value creation strategy - carve-outs and separations are increasingly structural mechanisms for reshaping portfolios and enabling more focused operating models.

AI-driven transformation of deal execution - AI adoption has moved beyond experimentation, embedding advanced analytics into diligence, modeling, and integration planning.

Execution discipline as a decisive source of advantage - repeatable separation, integration, governance, and talent continuity are increasingly defining outcomes as complexity becomes more visible and consequential.

Heading into Easter and closing the first quarter of 2026, I look forward to following the local M&A market developments and see if it can continue to demonstrate cross-Nordic resilience on the global stage. With strong strategic focus, carve-out readiness and disciplined execution, it will be interesting to which extent M&A momentum can carry forward into rest of the year.



[Access report: 2026 Global M&A Outlook](#)



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All underlying data for the Nordic Deal Trend Report is used courtesy of Mergermarket. All data is based on announced transactions over USD5m and is based on Mergermarket’s M&A deals database. Deals with undisclosed deal values are included where the target’s turnover exceeds USD10m. Deals where the effective stake acquired is less than 30 % will only be included if the value is greater than USD100m. Deals with lapsed or withdrawn bids are excluded. Please refer to Mergermarket for full deal criteria.

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